

## Suffixes

A suffix is added to the end of a root—which is either a whole word or part of a word—and changes its meaning or its part of speech. For example, adding the suffix *-ant* (meaning a person who performs an action) to the end of the word *account* results in a new word with a new meaning: *accountant*. On the other hand, the verb *exist* becomes the noun *existence* when the suffix *-ence* (“state of”) is added.

### REAL WORLD

#### Techno-prefixes

New affixes appear in English all the time, largely due to rapidly changing technology. For example, the prefix *e-* (meaning “electronic”) was created to form words such as *e-mail* and *e-commerce*. Similarly, the prefix *cyber-*, which refers to information technology, is used in the words *cyberspace* and *cybercafé*.



| Suffixes            | Meaning                       | Examples                |
|---------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>-able, -ible</b> | able to                       | sustainable, sensible   |
| <b>-acy</b>         | state or quality              | conspiracy              |
| <b>-age</b>         | action of                     | advantage               |
| <b>-age</b>         | collection                    | assemblage              |
| <b>-al</b>          | act of                        | denial                  |
| <b>-al, -ial</b>    | having characteristics of     | seasonal, controversial |
| <b>-ance, -ence</b> | state of                      | defiance, competence    |
| <b>-ant, -ent</b>   | person who performs an action | accountant, student     |
| <b>-ate</b>         | become                        | inflate                 |
| <b>-cian</b>        | profession of                 | technician              |
| <b>-cy</b>          | state of being                | accuracy                |
| <b>-dom</b>         | place or state of being       | freedom                 |
| <b>-ed</b>          | past tense                    | stopped                 |
| <b>-en</b>          | made of                       | golden                  |
| <b>-en</b>          | become                        | brighten                |
| <b>-ent</b>         | state of being                | different               |
| <b>-er, -or</b>     | person who performs an action | drummer, investigator   |
| <b>-er</b>          | more                          | shorter                 |
| <b>-ery</b>         | action of                     | robbery                 |
| <b>-ery</b>         | place of                      | bakery                  |
| <b>-esque</b>       | reminiscent of                | picturesque             |
| <b>-est</b>         | the most                      | shortest                |
| <b>-ette</b>        | small                         | maisonette              |
| <b>-ful</b>         | full of                       | cheerful                |
| <b>-hood</b>        | state of                      | childhood               |
| <b>-ia, -y</b>      | state of                      | amnesia, monarchy       |

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|----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------|
| <b>-ic, -tic,</b>    | having                | historic, poetic,      |
| <b>-ical</b>         | characteristics of    | radical                |
| <b>-ice</b>          | state or quality      | justice                |
| <b>-ify</b>          | make                  | magnify                |
| <b>-ing</b>          | present participle    | hopping                |
| <b>-ish</b>          | having the quality of | childish               |
| <b>-ism</b>          | the belief in         | modernism              |
| <b>-ist</b>          | one who               | artist                 |
| <b>-ite</b>          | one connected with    | socialite              |
| <b>-ity, -ty</b>     | quality of            | reality, society       |
| <b>-ive, -ative,</b> | tending to            | passive, superlative,  |
| <b>-itive</b>        |                       | sensitive              |
| <b>-less</b>         | without               | useless                |
| <b>-like</b>         | resembling            | childlike              |
| <b>-ling</b>         | small                 | halfling               |
| <b>-ly</b>           | how something is      | friendly               |
| <b>-ment</b>         | condition of, act of  | entertainment          |
| <b>-ness</b>         | state of              | happiness              |
| <b>-ous, -eous,</b>  | having qualities of   | ridiculous, nauseous,  |
| <b>-ious</b>         |                       | curious                |
| <b>-s, -es</b>       | more than one         | otters, foxes          |
| <b>-ship</b>         | state of              | friendship             |
| <b>-sion,</b>        | state of being        | intrusion, permission, |
| <b>-ssion, -tion</b> |                       | classification         |
| <b>-some</b>         | tending to            | cumbersome             |
| <b>-ward</b>         | in a direction        | backward               |
| <b>-y</b>            | characterized by      | stormy                 |